

```
# mkdir /secret
# mount /dev/mapper/name /secret
```

6. When finished, unmount the filesystem and run the following command:

```
# cryptsetup luksClose name
```

It will lock the encrypted volume, which can then only be reused by giving the password and mounting the volume.

— **Debasish Mirdha**,
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Monitor your changed files in real time, in Linux

We know that `top` is a command to monitor your CPU usage and processes in real time. Here is a tip that will allow you to monitor changes in files in real time.

Just run the following command and watch the output:

```
# watch -d -n 2 'df; ls -FIAt;'
```

The output will allow you to spy on which files are getting written on your system.

Every time a file gets modified, it will get highlighted in the output of the above command.

 **Note:** The above command is useful when you grant someone SSH access to your Linux computer and wish to know exactly what they are modifying.

— **Abhishek Chib**, abhishek.chib@gmail.com

Monitor user activity in real time

To monitor how many users are logged in and what they are doing, we can use the `w` command. The output we get informs us of the activities of all users who are logged in.

```
#w
```

USER	TTY	FROM	LOGIN@	IDLE	JCPU	PCPU
WHAT						
root	pts/2	10.42.8.124	09:59	48:33	2.50s	2.47s
watch w						
root	pts/3	10.42.8.124	09:59	0.00s	0.08s	0.00s

By using the following command you can monitor user activity:

```
#watch w
```

— **Kishor Talole**, kishorda_1986@yahoo.com

Find the processes using maximum memory



Sometimes our computer or server runs out of memory and we need to see which process is using the maximum memory. One way to do this is to open up the system monitor and go to the 'Process' tab. But this can only be done when you are logged in to your computer in graphical mode.

Given below is a tip that does the same for you on the command line. This can also be useful for those trying to do this on remote computers.

```
$ ps aux | tr -s " " | cut -d " " -f 4,11 | sort -n -r | uniq | head -10
```

The output shows the memory used by each application.

```
5.4 /usr/lib/firefox/firefox-bin
5.1 /usr/lib/thunderbird/thunderbird-bin
4.9 /usr/lib/libreoffice/program/soffice.bin
1.2 nautilus
1.1 python
1.0 mono
0.9 /usr/lib/firefox/plugin-container
0.9 /usr/bin/Xorg
0.8 /usr/bin/python
0.8 gedit
```

This command outputs the top ten processes consuming the maximum amount of memory. It is sorted by order of the highest to the lowest.

— **Praveen Chandran**,
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